全民英檢中級 GEPT Intermediate | 第 19 單元 | 自然與動物 · Nature & Animals

The Summer the Eggs Hatched

雞蛋孵化的那個夏天

When twelve-year-old Hsiao-yu was sent to her grandparents' farm in Yilan for the summer, she expected to be bored within a day. There was no convenience store, no Wi-Fi, and the nearest bus stop was a twenty-minute walk past a bamboo grove. On the first evening, she sat outside the old barn, listening to crickets in the dark, and counted the days until school started.

Her grandfather, who had spent fifty years in agriculture, had other plans. At dawn, he led her to the henhouse, where a dozen eggs were about to hatch. "Each chick will need a name," he said. By noon, three wet, tired creatures with yellow feathers had broken out of their shells, and Hsiao-yu had forgotten about her phone. Over the following weeks, she learned to feed the cattle, spread fertilizer on the rice fields, and tell a dragonfly from a damselfly. The soil in Yilan is fertile because of the rain, her grandfather explained, but a crop still fails if nobody cares for it.

One afternoon, a hawk circled above the yard, and the hens hid their chicks under the bushes. Hsiao-yu grabbed a broom, ready to fight the fierce bird, but her grandmother laughed. "The hawk is hungry, too," she said. "Every creature here is trying to live." Later, walking along the brook behind the farm, Hsiao-yu noticed a caterpillar on a blossom and, for the first time, did not scream.

When her parents arrived in late August, they found a daughter with brown arms, muddy shoes, and a notebook full of drawings of ducklings. Hsiao-yu is now in senior high school, and she has already decided to study agriculture. Her three chicks, by the way, grew into very loud hens.

重點單字 Key Vocabulary

單字	詞性	中文	例句
agriculture	*n.*	農業	Agriculture is still important to the economy of Yunlin. 農業對雲林的經濟仍然很重要。

barn	*n.*	穀倉；牲口棚	The farmer keeps his tractor in the barn. 農夫把他的曳引機停在穀倉裡。
hatch	*v.*	孵化	The eggs will hatch in about three weeks. 這些蛋大約三週後會孵化。
chick	*n.*	小雞	The chicks followed their mother around the yard. 小雞跟著母雞在院子裡走來走去。
creature	*n.*	生物；動物	The deep sea is home to many strange creatures. 深海是許多奇特生物的家。
feather	*n.*	羽毛	The peacock spread its colorful feathers. 孔雀展開牠色彩繽紛的羽毛。
fertilizer	*n.*	肥料	Too much fertilizer can harm the river. 過多的肥料可能會傷害河川。
fertile	*adj.*	肥沃的	The land near the river is fertile and good for rice. 河邊的土地肥沃，適合種稻。
hawk	*n.*	老鷹；鷹	A hawk can spot a mouse from high in the sky. 老鷹能從高空中發現一隻老鼠。
fierce	*adj.*	凶猛的；激烈的	The dog looked fierce, but it was actually friendly. 那隻狗看起來很凶，其實很友善。

片語 Phrases

be about to + V	即將；正要	The train is about to leave, so hurry up. 火車就要開了，快一點。
break out of	從…破出；逃出	The baby turtles broke out of their shells on the beach. 小海龜在沙灘上破殼而出。
tell A from B	分辨 A 與 B	Can you tell a frog from a toad? 你能分辨青蛙和蟾蜍嗎？

文法與句型 Grammar

S＋be＋about to＋V

「即將、正要…」，表示動作馬上就要發生。文章第二段：a dozen eggs were about to hatch.

The movie is about to start, so please turn off your phone.

電影即將開始，請關掉手機。

S＋had＋p.p.（過去完成式）

表示在過去某個時間點之前就已完成的動作，常與另一個過去的時間或動作對照。文章第二段：By noon, three creatures had broken out of their shells, and Hsiao-yu had forgotten about her phone.

By the time we arrived, the show had already begun.

我們到達時，表演已經開始了。

讀完文章後，請到「皇家大衛英文閱讀集點站」完成本單元測驗，答對即可累積點數。